

Creating Instapoetry with Canva

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LCWRI-5250: Electric Frontiers
Prof. Kemp
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Workshop Agenda

- Learn about the basics of instapoetry
- Review some best practices and examples of instapoetry
- Explore how to make instapoetry using Canva, a free online tool
- Consider accessibility in designing textual and graphical materia

SDG Report 2020

Instapoetry

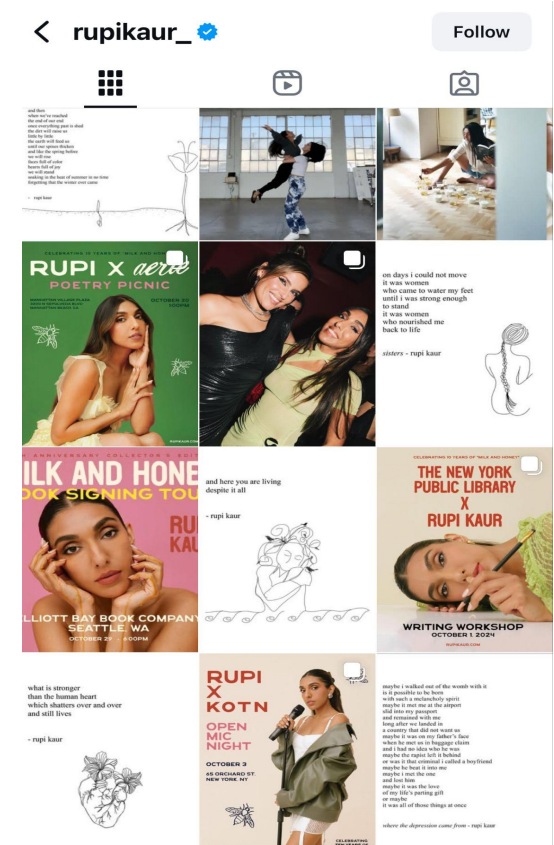
Instapoetry Basics 1/2

Instapoems often have textual and graphic components, which mean they tell a story through 1) words, 2) visuals, and 3) the relationship between the two. Here are some characteristics of instapoems:

- “Born digital”
- Short
 - some say “quick and digestible”—is this always the case?
- Simple visuals
- Shareable
- Complicated relationship to the tradition of poetry

Instapoetry Basics 2/2

- Entrepreneurial & poetic overlap:
Rupi Kaur, a famous poet-entrepreneur, said she approaches poetry like “running a business.”
- Self-portraiture: publishing your instapoetry on your instagram so that your personal grid and the instapoems you post constitute a kind of social media persona

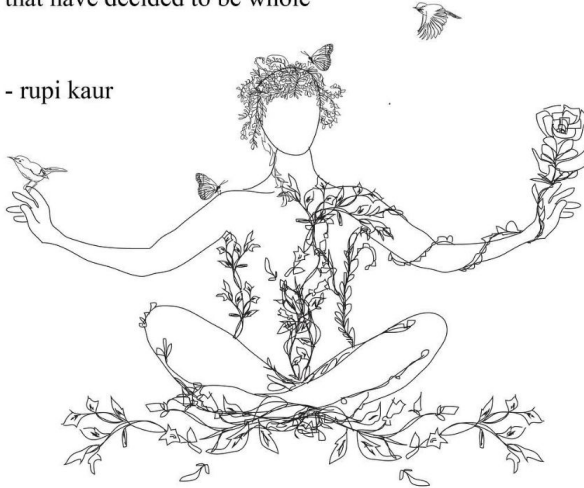


Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!

Instapoem Examples 1/3

it was when i stopped searching for home within others
and lifted the foundations of home within myself
i found there were no roots more intimate
than those between a mind and body
that have decided to be whole

- rupi kaur



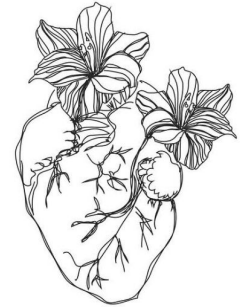
i tend to forget who i am
when i'm constantly around other people

i need solitude to see myself clearly - rupi kaur



what is stronger
than the human heart
which shatters over and over
and still lives

- rupi kaur



Instapoem Examples 2/3

Maybe, in the end, friendship is exactly
this: standing in awe as someone you love
becomes beautifully, fully themselves. It's
seeing them rise after countless falls,
hearing courage bloom in their voice,
noticing how their eyes brighten when
they're chasing dreams they once feared
were impossible. Friendship is witnessing
the quiet victories no one else might notice,
feeling pride swell inside your chest,
knowing you've held space for their journey
without needing to claim credit or applause.

It's realizing, finally, that friendship isn't
about holding on tight, but rather standing
beside them, amazed by how gracefully
they've learned to fly.

the truth is, hearts were never
made to stay broken. They heal
quietly, slowly, and gently—but
only when they're given the chance
to feel the sun's warmth again.

- r. m. drake

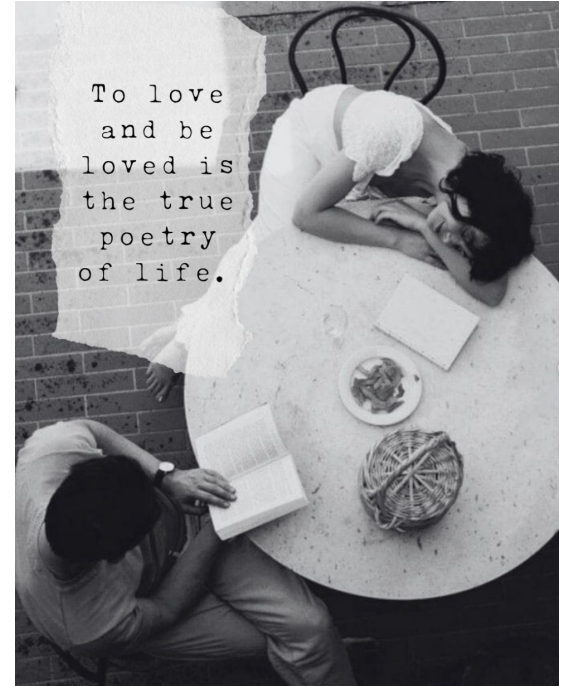
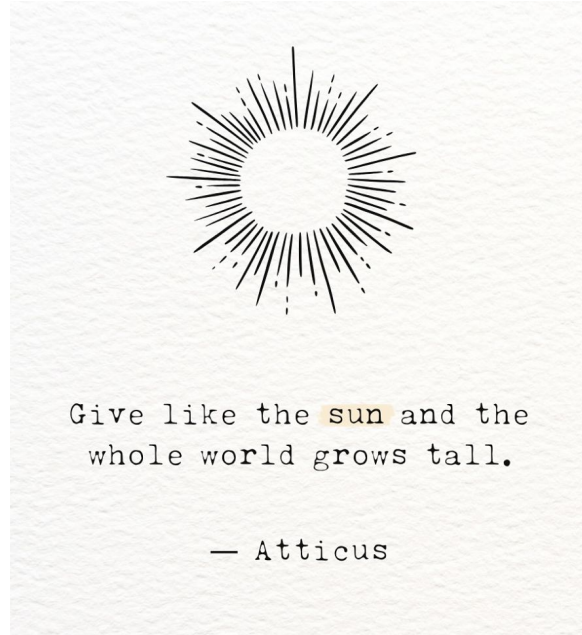
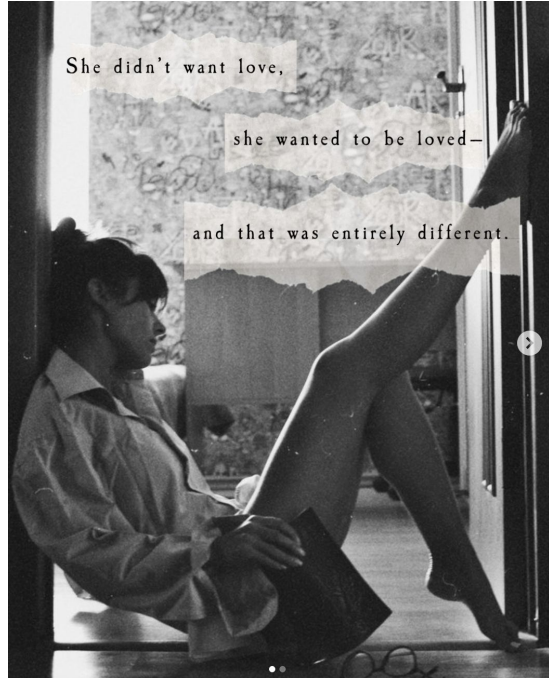
One day
the right kind of love
will find you.
And it will be
at the right time.
It will be
when you need it most.

-r. m

drake

R.M. Drake

Instapoem Examples 3/3



Atticus

Instapoetry Tips

- Create your instapoem with your publishing space in mind, e.g., Instagram, TikTok, Pinterest, and other social media platforms
 - Easy to read, respond to, and shared with others—with a distinct visual identity and/or theme
 - Straightforward language, minimal punctuation
 - Delves into the idealized themes of the platform, such as love, self-empowerment, mental health, and identity

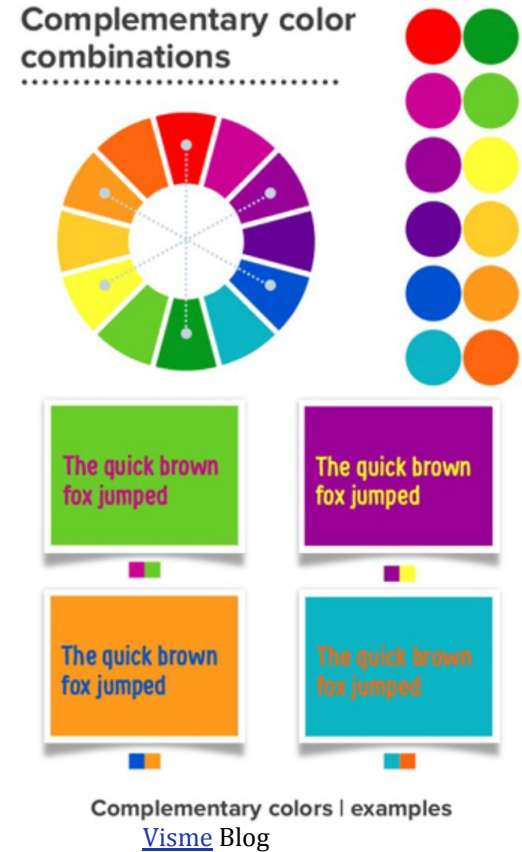
Accessibility in Instapoetry

- Make sure text is not cut off or covered by your images
- Add descriptive alt-text to your images
- Make sure you use high contrast colors
- Do not add layer text directly over images

For more information on **accessibility**, please see: [DITI accessibility handout](#)

Keep it Visible: Colors

- Make color choices that are accessible to everyone (and appropriate for the infographic).
- Ideal color schemes are **high contrast** (use a [contrast checker](#)).
- Think about limiting your palette (3 colors can be effective).
- Find complementary colors (e.g. use [this tool](#)).
- [NU Colors](#) provides the Northeastern University palette.



Getting Started with Canva

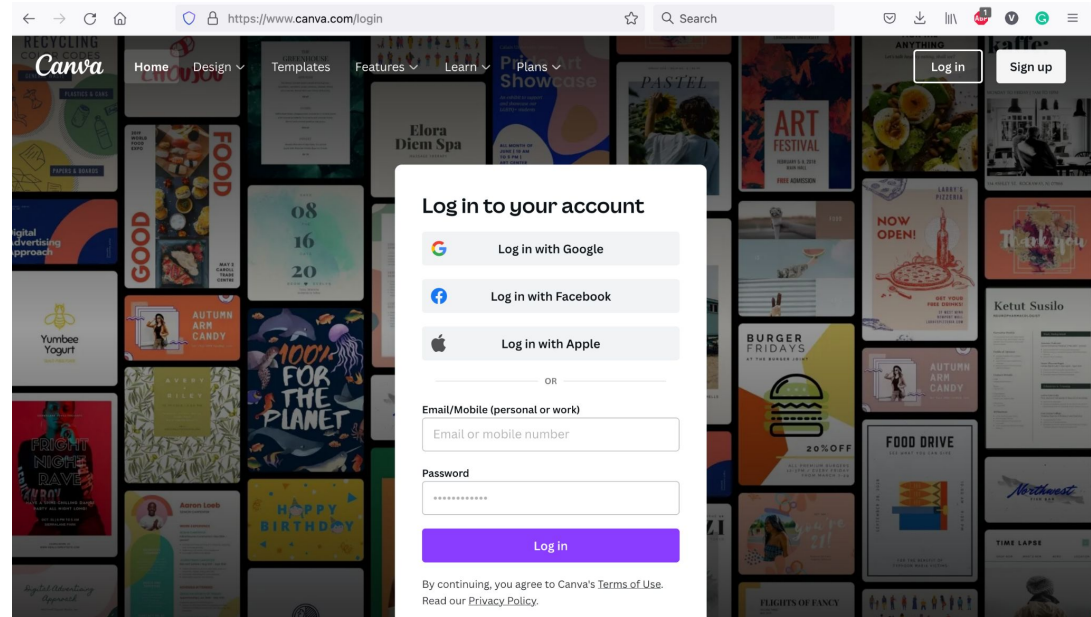
Data Privacy

- It's important to pay attention to data privacy when using digital resources
- At its simplest, **data privacy** is a person's ability to control what of their personal information is shared and with whom.
- To help you make informed decisions about interacting with digital tools in ways that honor your boundaries with your data and/or personal information, The DITI has prepared a handout on

Data Privacy

Sign up/Login

- Canva is a free online tool.
- Use your Gmail/Facebook/Apple ID to sign up or create an account.
- Click “Create A Design.”



Starting Up...

- First, pick your canvas dimensions. Canva features curated 'social media' sizes, so you can customize the width and length. You can also add more 'pages.'
 - Unfortunately, resizing and adding pages in an already existing graphic is only available in paid subscriptions.

Create a design

🔍 For you

📄 Sheets

📁 Docs

📌 Whiteboards

🗨️ Presentations

📱 Social media

📷 Photo editor

📺 Videos

🔍 What would you like to create?

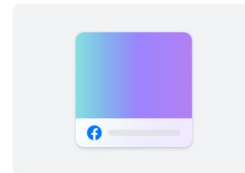
Popular

Instagram

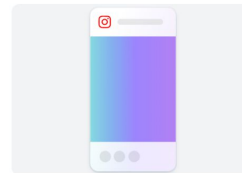
Facebook

LinkedIn

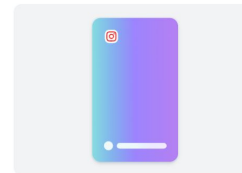
Popular



Facebook Post (Landscape)



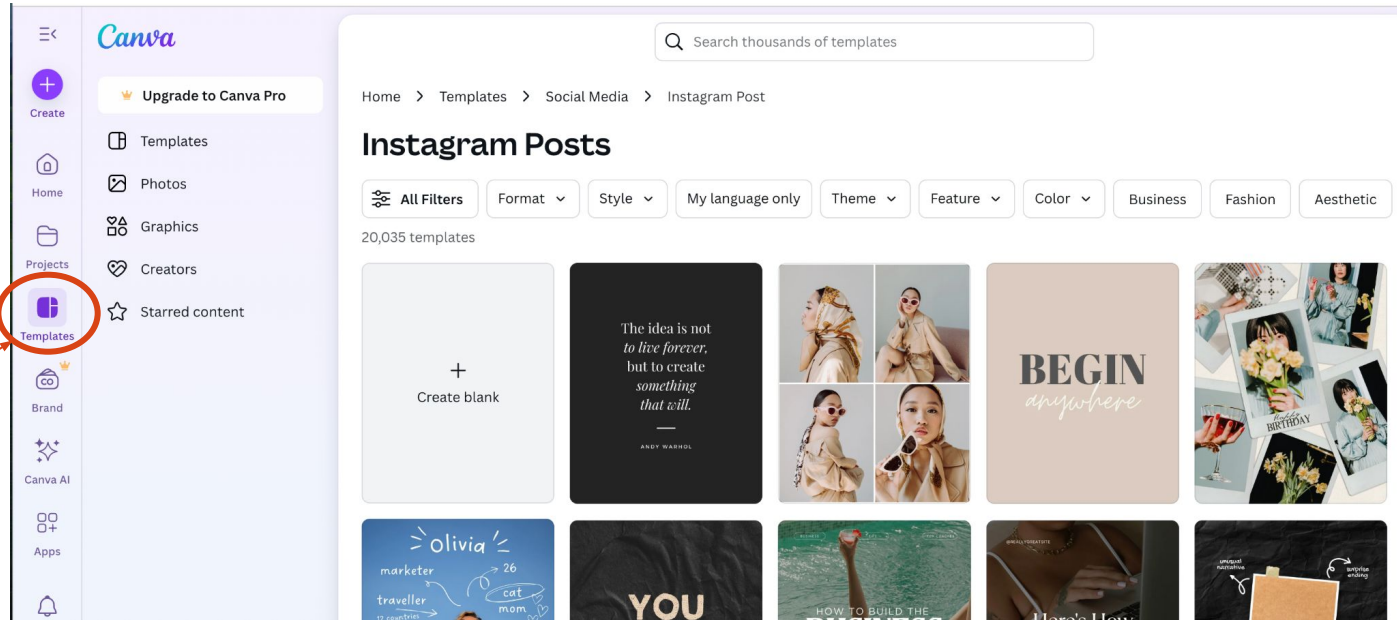
Instagram Post (4:5)



Instagram Story

Pick a Style

- If you need some help or inspiration, Canva offers several social media templates you can start from.



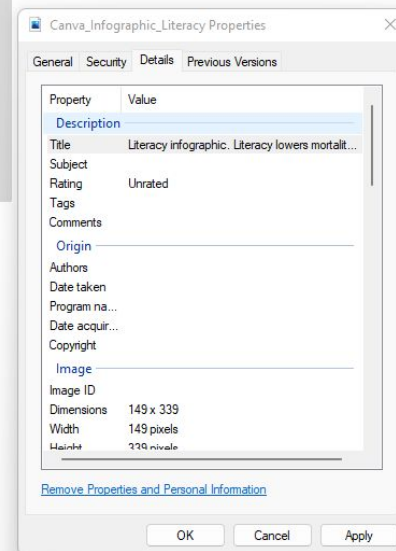
Layers

- Canva works by combining several graphic layers.
- Layers can be anything that shows up on the canvas—elements, photos, text, etc.—and can be customized in many ways. You can drag them around, change their colors, resize them, and more!
- Remember that you can always send a layer ‘forward’ or ‘back’ relative to other layers with a right click on PC, control click on Macs

Alt-Text

- Alt-text is a description of an image that conveys the image content and meaning. This descriptive text is attached to the image's file properties.
- People with low or no vision can use assistive technology like screen readers to hear the alt-text description of digital images. When a screen reader reaches the image, it will read the alt-text description out loud.

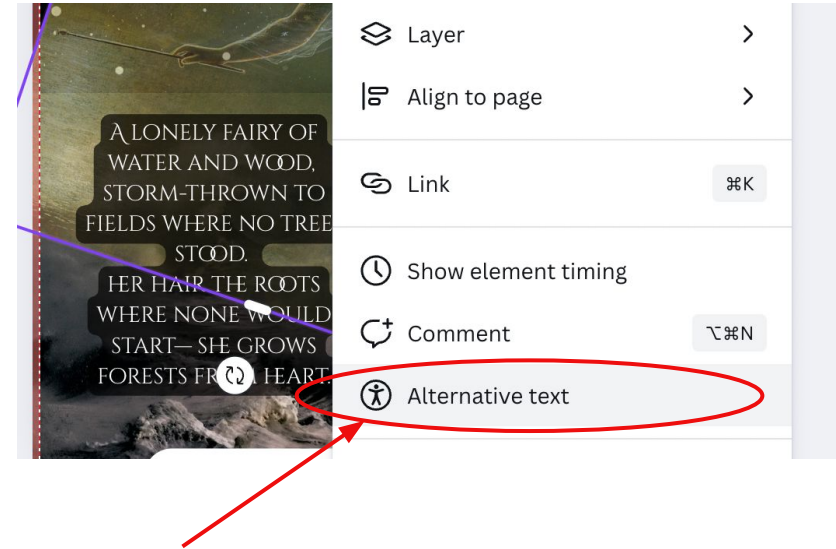
> OneDrive - Northeastern University > Pictures > Canva



Based on : [Microsoft's How to write effective alt-text](#)

Adding Alt-Text in Canva 1/2

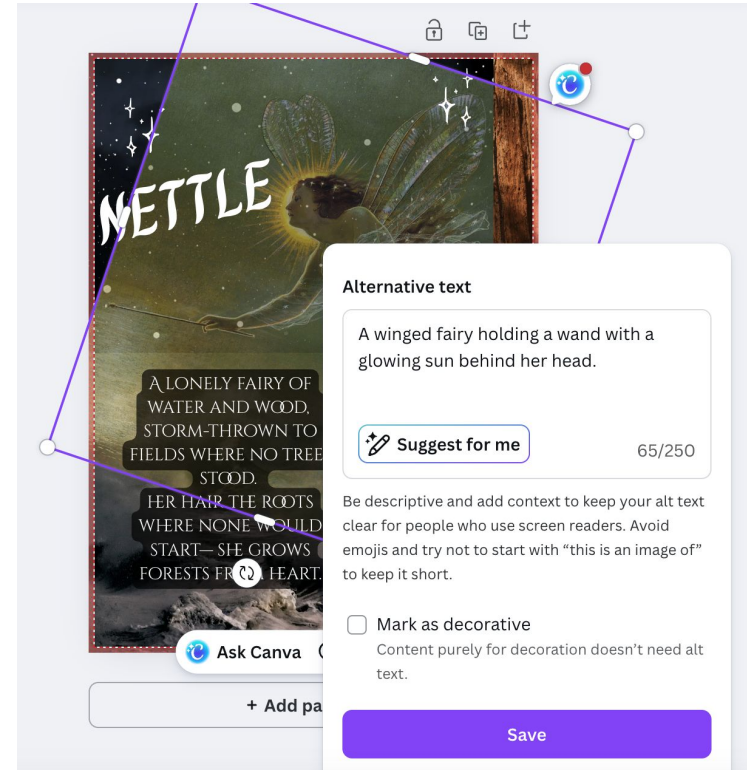
In the Canva editing page, double-click on your image, and a menu will open to the right (the same menu as when you add layers). Click on the option for “Alternative text”



Adding Alt-Text in Canva 2/2

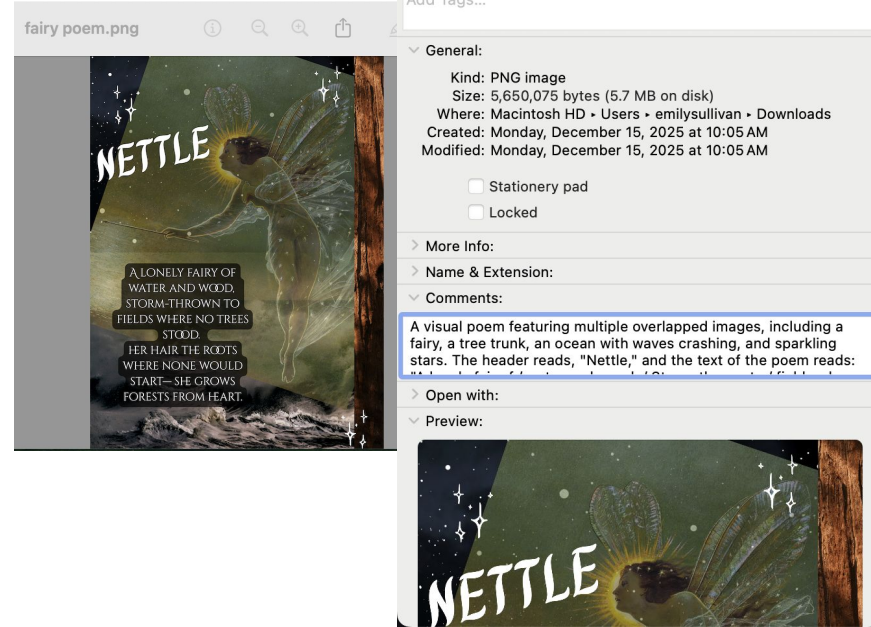
A text bubble will appear where you can add the descriptive alt-text.

Note: this method means that you can add alt-text to each image separately, which is especially important if you are creating a file that contains multiple overlapping images or elements.



Adding Alt-Text to a downloaded image file

- You can export your infographic as an image and then add alt-text.
- Find the image in your file directory.
- On PC: Right-click the image and select 'Properties.' Choose the 'Details' tab and click on the 'Title' field.
- On Mac: Control-click the image and select 'Get Info' on Macs, then edit the 'Comments' field.
- Write a description of and insights from your infographic.



Your Turn!

Practice creating an Instapoem in Canva

Hands On

Questions to consider as you work:

- How can visuals enhance your poem?
- What elements of your poem do you think could be improved by being presented visually?
- What are some obstacles you might face when creating instapoetry?



For Further Exploration

Here are links to the handouts presented in these slides:

[DITI-accessibility-handout](#)

[DITI-data-privacy-handout](#)

[NULab Meet the Method: Canva](#)

See also the [Beginner's Guide](#), published by Canva

*Feel free to ask questions at any
point during the presentation!*

Thank you!

Developed by DITI Research and Teaching Fellows Emily Sullivan, Zhen Guo, Claire Lavarreda, Carlos Arriaga Serrano, Kasya O'Connor Grant, Dipa Desai, and Javier Rosario

- For more information on DITI, please see: <https://bit.ly/diti-about>
- Schedule an appointment with us! <https://bit.ly/diti-meeting>
- If you have any questions, contact us at: nulab.info@gmail.com

Feel free to ask questions at any point during the presentation!